

B2 First for Schools Writing Paper Part 2

Aims of the lesson	To familiarise students with the text types in Part 2 of the Writing Test
Time needed	50 - 60 minutes
Materials required	- Student worksheet 1 – cut up (1 per ten students) - Student worksheets 2 and 3 (1 per student) - Student worksheet 4 (1 per student)

Procedure

- Before the class, photocopy **Student's worksheet 1** and cut it up so that each student can have either the name of a text type or an example of a text type.
- Tell the students that there are five different task types they may be expected to produce in Part 2, and that you are going to look at them briefly in this activity. Remind or tell them that they only have to write one task in Part 2, and that they can choose one out of questions 2–4, or a set text question.
- If there are more than ten students, divide the students into two or three groups which will mingle in different areas of the classroom and distribute the pieces of paper from **Student's worksheet 1** evenly between the students. Some students may have to have more than one piece of paper and find more than one partner.
- Students either have the name of a text type, or an example of a text. They have to find a partner with whom they can match the extract with the text type. They are all task types that candidates may be required to write in Part 2 of the B2 First for Schools Writing paper.

Alternative to **3.** and **4.**: if you have a lot of students and mingling is difficult, simply cut up the cards into sets and give them out to the students in groups of three or four. The students match the pairs.

- When students have found their partner(s), in their groups students lay out the strips so that each task type matches an example, and:
 - agree as a group that each pairing is correct.
 - decide what the task for each text is (e.g. a review of a film, a letter of advice to a friend about going on a trip, etc.)
- Feed back some ideas with the whole class (see **Answer key**). If appropriate, draw attention to features of the text which give you information about the target reader (audience) of the text.
- Give students a copy of the sample material -. Ask students to work in pairs and identify the text types that candidates are required to write for each question. Get them to choose their first choice of question and their last choice and discuss the reasons for their choices with their partner. (*Text types: 2 – letter; 3 – review; 4 – story; 5 – essay*).

8. Get feedback from students about why they like certain questions and why they dislike other questions. Elicit the fact that with a plan of how to write a text and with practice students may be able to gain confidence with a particular question. There is obviously no correct answer to this. However, I think reviews are seen as difficult when in fact they are not. This is because we give reviews all the time when talking with friends about the latest video game, film and so on. Plus, the language of reviews is quite formulaic and can be repeated in most reviews.
9. Give the example of the story question (**question 4**) and ask students for some ideas on how they would go about writing the answer to this question.
Point out/ elicit that the main reason for writing would be to get the interest of the reader. When writing a story, you have to find inspiration and details to make your story colourful and interesting for the reader.
10. Give out **Student's worksheet 3** and ask students to complete it in pairs. When they have finished, elicit feedback from the whole class (see **Answer key** below).
11. Do students feel that this advice on story writing would help them tackle the story question in the sample paper (**question 4**)? Tell them that a nice alternative to planning a story in the traditional paragraph structure way is to decide the events and put them on a timeline. This has the advantage of making the choice of tenses easier. If they need to jump back in time to refer to earlier events to explain why, for example, the boy had somebody else's suitcase, it will be easier to know to describe these using past perfect tenses. Control of narrative tenses is an important aspect of story writing and something the examiner pays special attention to.
12. If time, hand out **Student's worksheet 4** and ask students to quickly read the text for the main idea. Next ask them to put the verbs into the correct tense. After a few minutes check to see if they were correct (see **Answer key** below). It is based on the story from **Student worksheet 1**. This will give you an idea if the class need extra help with narrative tenses.
13. Next ask them to look at the words in *italics*. Tell them that the words are fine and ask them what the problem is. The answer is that they are boring vocabulary. Give the students 2 minutes to try to think of more interesting alternatives (see **Answer key**). During feedback tell them that this is an important part of checking any writing and encourage them to do it.
14. Next ask them to look at the gaps. Ask the student what type of words goes in the gaps, the answer is adverbs and time phrases. Do the first one as an example and ask the class to try to fill in the other gaps. During feedback (see **Answer key**) tell them that this is an important part of checking writing and encourage them to do it.
15. For homework ask the class to write the story from the sample paper.

Additional information

For more information about assessment criteria, see the B2 First for Schools Handbook.

For more information on the set text questions, see the B2 First for Schools Handbook.

Reading the set text in class increases students' options in the Writing paper. It's also possible to use the film version of the set text if this is preferred. If you are not studying the set text, make sure the students know that if they choose question 5, they should know the book or the film as they must refer to it in their answer. They might know it in their own language, which is fine, but they must know something about it in order to write a relevant answer.

Suggested follow up activities

1. Students answer one of the questions from the **Sample tasks** for homework. They could write an answer to Question 4 as they have looked at the advice on how to answer it (**Student's worksheet 3**)
2. Students will need guidance on how to plan the different types of writing task, and useful language for each, e.g. narrative tenses for stories, linkers, etc. During the course, students will need plenty of practice in planning and writing the different text types. Some of this work can be started in class (e.g. brainstorming ideas, planning which points to make) and completed for homework.
3. Give students practice during the course in planning and writing all the different text types required in the B2 First for Schools Writing paper.

Answer key

Procedure step 6

Agree as a group that each pairing is correct (see **Student's worksheet 1** for correct pairs).

Task for each text (possible answers)

article	for a magazine or school newsletter about food in your country, or comparing the food of your country with others
letter	advice to a friend about going on a trip, changing course, etc
review	film review, e.g. a comedy, animation, etc
story	e.g. Write a story for your teacher which begins " <i>Peter never imagined that a game of football could turn out the way it did.</i> "
essay	e.g. set by a teacher: This will only be about the set text . Your English class has had a discussion about the story of Macbeth. Now your teacher has given you this essay for homework: Which character do you find most interesting in Macbeth and why?

Worksheet 3

1 beginning	7 two
2 middle	8 linking words and phrases
3 end	9 tenses
4 before	10 put the events in a story in order
5 paragraphs	11 adjectives and adverbs
6 sentence	

Worksheet 4

Peter never imagined that a game of football could turn out the way it did. He and his friends had been playing for about half an hour when **stupidly** he had kicked the ball too hard. **Unfortunately** it had gone down the hill.

Peter *ran* down the hill as fast as he could trying to catch the football before it went in the river. **Suddenly** he was at the river bank, but he lost his balance and fell in. Luckily Peter was a good swimmer so he managed to catch the ball. However, he was in the middle *going* towards the centre of town.

In no time he passed under the main bridge and he saw a policeman who was walking over the bridge. Peter *called* for help and before he knew it the policeman had thrown him a rope and he was saved.

Afterwards, Peter had to explain to his parents what had happened, but they were so *happy* that they weren't angry. To this day Peter has tried to keep his football and swimming separate.

2. *ran* – raced/rushed/sped

going – racing/speeding/being swept

called – shouted/screamed/yelled

happy – relieved/delighted/pleased

3. Answers highlighted in the text above.

Student's worksheet 1

Article	Most people will probably agree with me that the food in our country is the best in the world! Personally, I think this is because we appreciate the importance of eating well, and many people enjoy cooking. My favourite dish is...
Letter/email	If your parents don't think this is a good idea, maybe you could ask your brother to help you to change their minds. I remember you told me that he did the same thing himself four years ago. Why don't you...
Review	I think that people of all ages would enjoy this film, and I would recommend it for a fun family trip to the cinema.
Story	Peter ran down the hill as fast as he could, trying to catch the football before it went into the river. Suddenly, ...
Essay (on set text)	In my opinion, Lady Macbeth is the most interesting character because she is so determined, strong and powerful.

Student's worksheet 2

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Write an answer to **one** of the questions 2 – 5 in this part. Write your answer in **140 – 190** words in an appropriate style **on the separate answer sheet**. Put the question number in the box at the top of the answer sheet.

- 2 You have received a letter from your English-speaking pen friend.

Can you help me with a class project? I have to write about places which are special to people. Can you tell me about a place that is special to you? Where is it? What does it look like? It doesn't have to be a famous place. Just explain why it's important to you.
Write soon, Sam

Write your **letter**.

- 3 You see this advert in an international fashion magazine:

Reviews Wanted

Teenage Clothes Shop



We are looking for reviews of a clothes shop for teenagers where you live. Your review should include information about what the shop looks like, the kind of clothes it sells and the shop assistants. Would you recommend this shop to other people your age?

The best reviews will be published in next month's magazine.



Write your **review**.

- 4 You have seen this announcement in a new English-language magazine for young people.

Stories wanted

We are looking for stories for our new English-language magazine for young people. Your story must **begin** with this sentence:

Tom got off the train and as the train left, he realised he was holding the wrong suitcase.

Your story must include:

- an address
- a surprise

Write your **story**.

- 5 Answer the following question based on the title below.

Macbeth by William Shakespeare

Your English class has had a discussion about the story of *Macbeth*. Now your teacher has given you this essay for homework:

Which character do you find most interesting in *Macbeth* and why?

Write your **essay**.

Student's worksheet 3

Read the following text and complete the gaps with the words and phrases in the box.

Paragraphs	middle	before	two	tenses
adjectives and adverbs	end	put the events in a story in order	beginning	
linking words and phrases	sentence			

What makes a good story?

A story should have a 1) _____, a 2) _____ and an 3) _____.

Think about how the story begins, the main events and how it ends. Do this 4) _____ starting to write your story. As with other types of writing, you should use 5) _____ to organise the text into sections. You should also write a plan or put the events on a timeline.

The short story tasks in the exam are based on a 6) _____ which students have to put at the beginning of their story. The story must be logically linked to this. There are also 7) _____ points that students must include in their story.

You can help the reader to follow your story by introducing events and linking them together using 8) _____, e.g. *before*, *afterwards*, *while*.

In a narrative, it is important to use a variety of 9) _____, e.g. past simple, past continuous, past perfect, to 10) _____ and to put them into perspective. Make the story interesting by adding details and colour; e.g. expand short sentences by adding description, for example using 11) _____.

Student's worksheet 4

1. Fill in the tenses from the verbs in **bold**

Peter never imagined that a game of football could turn out the way it did. He and his friends _____ (**play**) for about half an hour when **he had kicked the ball** too hard. _____ **it** _____ (**go**) down the hill.

Peter *ran* down the hill as fast as he could trying to catch the football before it went in the river. _____ he _____ (**be**) at the river bank, but he lost his balance and fell in. Luckily Peter was a good swimmer so he _____ (**manage**) to catch the ball. However, now he was in the middle *going* towards the centre of town.

_____ he passed under the main bridge and he _____ (**see**) a policeman who _____ (**walk**) over the bridge. Peter *called* for help and before he knew it the policeman had thrown him a rope and he was saved.

_____, Peter had to explain to his parents what _____ (**happen**), but they were so *happy* that they weren't angry. To this day Peter _____ (**try**) to keep his football and swimming separate.

2. Look at the words in italics. What is wrong with them? Try to think of a more interesting alternative.

3. Put the following adverbs and time phrases in the highlighted gaps:

- In no time
- Suddenly
- Stupidly
- Afterwards
- Unfortunately